

for the most Test hundreds. Over the last four years, the Yorkshire-born batter has more than doubled his century count. Root needs only three centuries per year for the next five years to overtake Sachin's ton tally.

Root's recent exploits have not only elevated him to the realm of all-time greats but have also left his contemporaries in the dust.

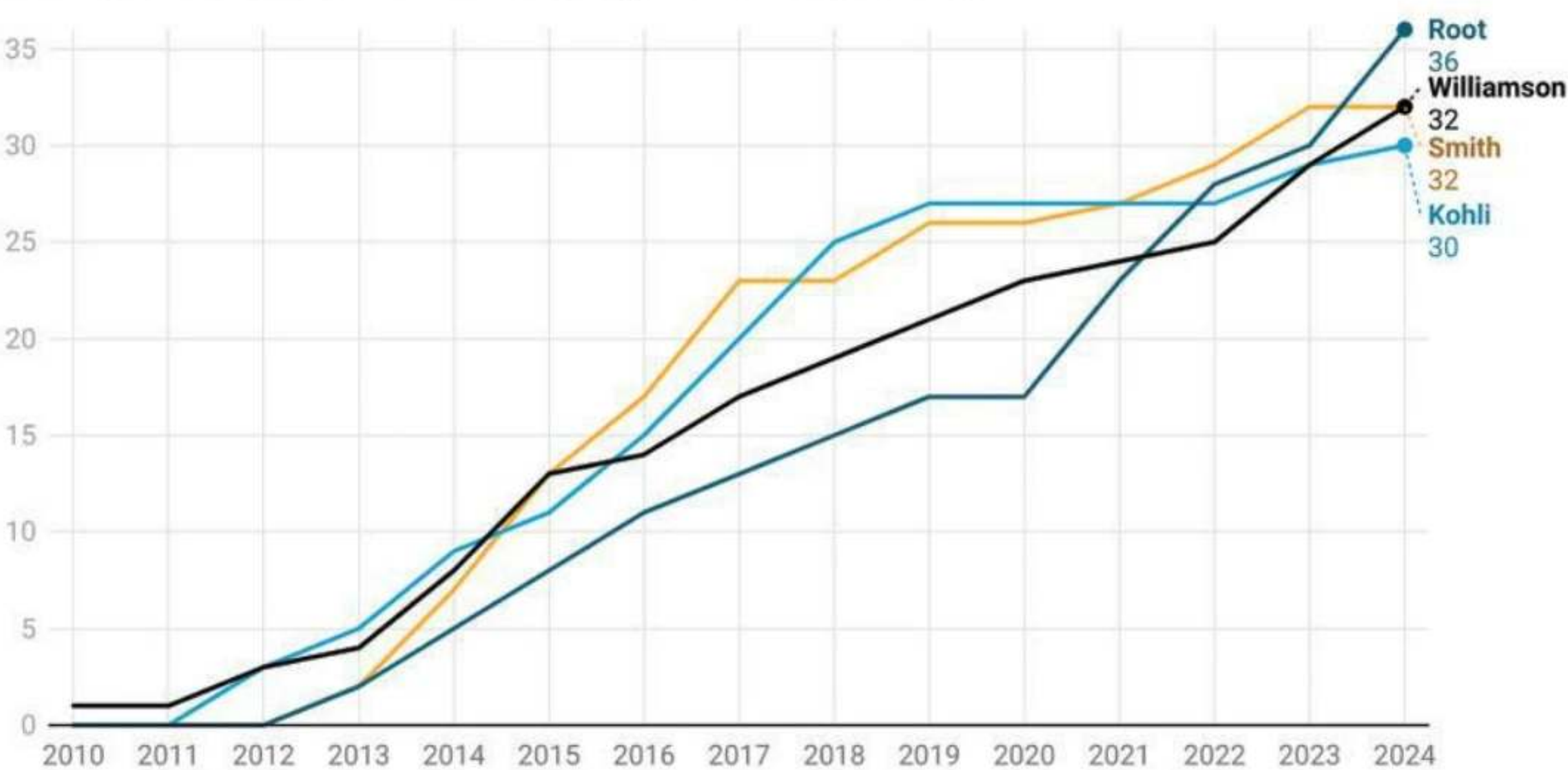
In the wake of Tendulkar's retirement in 2013, a vacuum emerged in Test cricket, soon filled by a clutch of batters who came to be known as the Fab Four – Steve Smith, Kane Williamson, Virat Kohli, and Root.

The Fab Four (a term coined by Kiwi legend Martin Crowe in 2014) have dominated world cricket over the past decade. However, in the group's early years, Root's inclusion often seemed like an afterthought, as he struggled to match the feats of the other three.

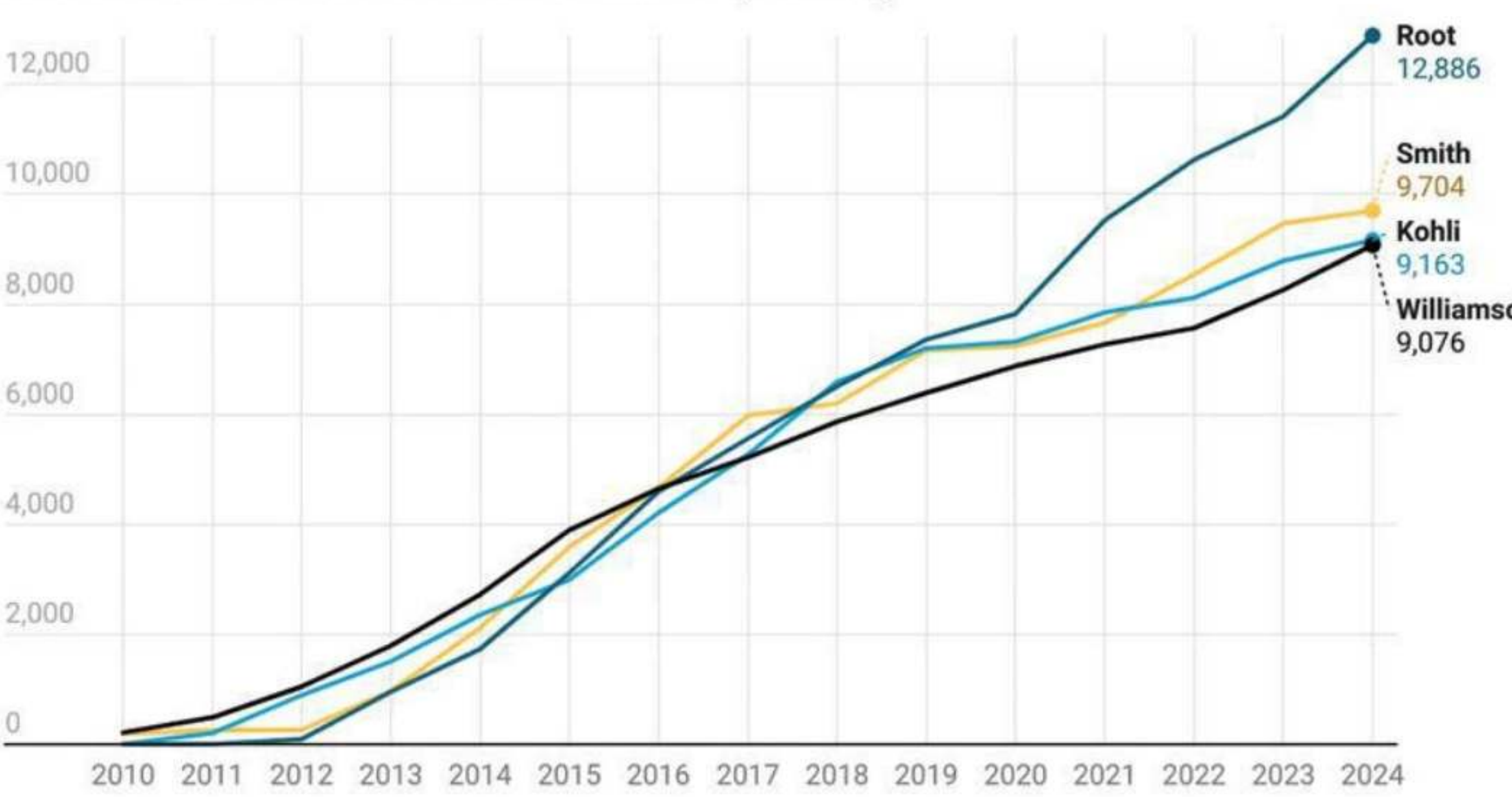
Until 2020, the four were largely neck-and-neck in the race to the 10k Test run tally. In terms of Test centuries, Root had the fewest among the four at the start of the decade, trailing Kohli by 10.

But Root has shattered this narrative over the last five years, outpacing the other three in almost every Test-related metric. His rise has been aided by the rest of the quartet grappling with the vagaries of poor form and injuries.

Fab-four cumulative century tallies (Tests)



Fab-four cumulative run tallies (Tests)



ALL TIME RECORD

Sachin Tendulkar (INDIA)



1989-2013

MATCHES	200
RUNS	15921
HS.	248*
AVG.	53.78
CENTURIES	51

Ricky Ponting (AUSTRALIA)



1995-2012

MATCHES	168
RUNS	13378
HS.	257
AVG.	51.85
CENTURIES	41

Jacques Kallis (ICC/SA)



1995-2013

MATCHES	166
RUNS	13289
HS.	224
AVG.	55.37
CENTURIES	45

Rahul Dravid (ICC/INDIA)



1996-2012

MATCHES	164
RUNS	13288
HS.	270
AVG.	52.31
CENTURIES	36

Joe Root (ENGLAND)



2012-2024*

MATCHES	151
RUNS	12886
HS.	262
AVG.	50.93
CENTURIES	36

*Root is still an active player; All numbers until December 12, 2024.